

Readings-week-1

Week 1: AI Fundamentals

Learning Objectives

- Define artificial intelligence
- Understand the history of AI
- Distinguish between different types of AI systems

Required Readings

Reading 1: What is Artificial Intelligence?

Source: [Your source here]

Length: ~15 minutes

Artificial intelligence refers to computer systems designed to perform tasks that typically require human intelligence. This foundational reading covers:

- Definition and scope of AI
- Historical development from the 1950s to present
- Different AI paradigms (symbolic AI, machine learning, deep learning)
- Current applications and limitations

Key Questions to Consider: 1. How has the definition of AI evolved over time? 2. What are the main limitations of current AI systems? 3. Why is it important to understand AI history when examining society?

Reading 2: Machine Learning Basics

Source: [Your source here]

Length: ~20 minutes

Introduction to machine learning as a subset of AI, including:

- Supervised vs. unsupervised learning
- Training, validation, and testing
- Common algorithms and their applications
- Real-world examples

Key Questions to Consider: 1. How does machine learning differ from traditional programming? 2. Why do training datasets matter for AI performance? 3. What could go wrong if training data is biased?

Discussion Points

Bring these questions to class or the discussion forum:

1. What AI systems do you interact with daily?
2. What excites you about AI? What concerns you?
3. How do you think AI will change society in the next 10 years?

Optional Supplementary Materials

- Video: “[Video Title]” - [Duration] - Embedded below or linked
- Infographic: AI Timeline from 1950-2026